Primo Assalto di Spada da Due Mani

Achille Marozzo, Opera Nova (Bologna, 1536), Book III, chapter 161

1 *Prima parte*

fallaci
Guardia di testa
Feint a falso impuntato outside his sword
left foot steps
Guardia di faccia, left foot forward
Mandritto to the head with a tramazzone
right foot steps
Porta di ferro larga
parato di filo dritto
He attacks: parry with the true edge, thrust to his face
right foot steps across in front of the left
Guardia di faccia
Roverso fendente to the head
left foot steps to his right side
Coda longa e alta
retreat through croce
He attacks again: cross the arms, point to his face
left foot steps up to the right
Guardia di croce
Rising falso dritto to the hands
right foot steps two spans back, left foot steps back behind it
Porta di ferro alta

2 *Seconda parte*

Porta di ferro alta
ponta incrosiata
Beat his falso thrust out with the false edge
crossed thrust to the face
left foot steps strongly forward
Coda longa e alta
He takes the bait: rising falso to his right hand
right foot steps to his left side, left foot steps in behind
Porta di ferro stretta
Then a tramazzone
left foot steps forward
Cinghiara porta di ferro
retreat through croce
He attacks: parry in croce
left foot steps up to the right
Guardia di croce
Rising falso to the hands
right foot steps two spans back, left foot steps strongly back behind it
Porta di ferro larga

3 *Terza parte*

urto di falso
Porta di ferro larga
Rising falso: beat his sword strongly to your right
left foot steps up to the right, feet together
Porta di ferro alta
Mandritto tondo to the legs
right foot steps strongly forward
Porta di ferro larga
lassalo andare a vodo
Recover, point to his face
right foot steps back beside the left
Guardia di faccia
He takes the bait: feign the parry, void
roverso fendente to the head
left foot steps to his right side
Coda longa e alta
retreat through croce
Defend
left foot steps up to the right
Guardia di croce
Rising falso dritto to the hands
right foot steps two spans back, then left foot steps behind the right
Porta di ferro alta

4 *Quarta parte*

Porta di ferro alta
Tramazzoncello
left foot steps to his right side
che tiri e intri
Cinghiara porta di ferro stretta
Thrust in falsata outside, over his sword, to his left temple
mandritto tondo to the legs
Guardia d'intrare in largo passo
Crossed thrust inside to the face
half mandritto to his right leg
right foot steps forward
●
lassalo andare a vodo
Parry with the true edge
right foot steps back beside the left
Guardia di faccia
Roverso fendente
left foot steps to his right side
Coda longa e alta
retreat through croce
Defend
left foot steps up to the right
Guardia di croce
Rising falso dritto to the hands
right foot steps two spans back, then left foot steps strongly behind the right
Porta di ferro alta

5 *Quinta parte*

Porta di ferro alta
Tramazzone beating his sword, thrust in falso over it to his face
rising roverso ridoppio to the arms (or a presa with the left hand)
or: mandritto to the head with a tramazzone
left foot steps to his right side; left foot steps strongly forward; right foot steps to his left side
Porta di ferro larga
Parry false edge rising
roverso sgualembrato to his right temple
left foot steps strongly to his right side
Coda longa e distesa
Fugge e cruove
right foot steps back behind the left
the turns
Cinghiara porta di ferro stretta
Embellish: right turn (left foot drawn to the right), left turn
left foot takes a large step to his right
Guardia d'intrare in largo passo

6 *Sesta parte*

Guardia d'intrare in largo passo
Falso manco
feign a tramazzone high
right foot steps strongly forward to the right, then left foot steps toward his right side
●
Roverso to the leg
Coda longa e distesa
Crossed thrust above the hand to the face
half turn of the hands
left foot steps behind the right
Porta di ferro alta

7 *Settima parte*

ponta incrosiata
Porta di ferro alta
Crossed thrust outside his sword to his left temple
rising falso dritto to the hands
left foot steps to his right side, then right foot steps to his left side
●
Tramazzone
left foot steps to his right side
Cinghiara porta di ferro stretta
Falso manco, withdraw the arms
left foot steps behind the right
Porta di ferro alta

8 *Ottava parte*

Porta di ferro alta
Rising falso manco strikes his sword
left foot steps up to the right, feet together
che tiri e intri
Porta di ferro alta
Mandritto tondo to the head
right foot steps strongly forward
Guardia di faccia
Mandritto tondo to the leg
Porta di ferro larga
lassalo andare a vodo
Tira e intra, arms extended
right foot steps back beside the left
Guardia d'intrare (non in largo passo)
Roverso fendente to the head
left foot steps to his right side
Coda longa e alta
retreat through croce
Thrust to the face
left foot steps up to the right
Guardia di croce
Rising falso to the forward leg
right foot steps two spans back, left foot steps strongly behind it
Porta di ferro alta

9 *Nona parte*

ponta incrosiata
Porta di ferro alta
Crossed thrust outside his sword to the face
uncross the arms over his sword
dritto traversato across the throat or face, with a tramazzone
left foot steps to his right side, right foot steps forward, then right foot takes a great step back
Cinghiara porta di ferro stretta
Beat his blow out with the false edge
mandritto sgualembrato to the face, tramazzone
right foot steps forward
●
lassalo andare a vodo
Parry
right foot steps back to the left
Guardia di faccia
Roverso fendente to the head
left foot steps to his right side
Coda longa e alta
retreat through croce
Thrust to the face
left foot steps up to the right
Guardia di croce
Rising falso to the hands
right foot steps two spans back, then left foot steps back behind it
Porta di ferro alta

10 *Decima e ultima parte*

the turns
Porta di ferro alta
Embellish via guardia di consentire
step a right turn, then a left turn
left foot steps to the side
Guardia d'intrare in largo passo
Crossed thrust inside, false edge to his true
half mandritto to his right leg
roverso sgualembrato
right foot steps in behind
●
Fugge e cruove
Cinghiara porta di ferro alta
Brandish the sword
left foot steps behind the right
Guardia di testa
Mandritto
right foot steps behind the left
Guardia di spalla
Right turn, left foot to the right; left turn, great step
point to the ground, left hand on the pommel, right foot steps to the left heel, right hand on the hip
Guardia di piede

🟥 high guards
🟦 porta di ferro guards
🟩 guardia d'intrare
🟪 low guards

Blows above each arrow, footwork below in italics. Each part begins in the guard where the last one ended.

- *retreat through croce: from guardia di croce, rising falso to the hands, right foot two spans back, into porta di ferro.*
- *lassalo andare a vodo: let his blow go (or take it in faccia), then a roverso fendente into coda longa e alta.*
- *che tiri e intri: a mandritto tondo or roverso trivellato carried straight into guardia d'intrare.*
- *ponta incrosiata: a crossed thrust: the arms together, the point to the face.*
- *urto di falso: beat his sword with the false edge, feet drawn together, then a mandritto tondo to the legs, right foot stepping forward.*
- *fallaci: deceive him: feint a falso impuntato, then pass left and right with a mandritto and tramazzone.*
- *parato di filo dritto: a true-edge parry that drives the point into his face in the same motion.*
- *the turns: volta dritta and volta manca, ending in guardia d'intrare in largo passo.*